

TRUE STORY

**I wrote 9 lines
of Python.
Never ran it.**

**Both bugs died
on execution #1.**

I'm a Test Engineer.

I test other people's code for a living.

This time, I didn't test my own.

THE CODE

```
def most_common_word(text):  
    words = re.findall(r'\w+', text)  
    counts = Counter(words)  
    top = max(counts.values())  
    return min(w for w,c in counts.items()  
               if counts == top) ⚠
```

Two one-character mistakes.

counts should have been c.

The logic was right.

The code did not work.

REAL DATA

48%

**of coding-interview candidates
now get flagged for leaning
on AI mid-interview.**

Up from 9% — a year ago.

34%

**of companies ban AI
outright in interviews.**

Most of the rest allow it —
only if you can explain and
defend what it produced.

**Banned or allowed —
same thing gets
tested.**

**Can you verify
what you wrote.**

Not just produce it.

22/**25**

**The 3 misses were Python —
the language I write every
day at work.**

Not a knowledge gap.

A fluency gap.

Documenting the real numbers
as I go.

Week 1 starts Monday.